

Dialogue Rooms Norway

Four public meetings for freedom of expression, trust and democratic participation

APPLICANT	PROPOSED PERIOD	LOCATIONS	FRITT ORD REQUEST
The Dialogue Platform	February-June 2027	Lillestrom and Oslo	NOK 100,000

PURPOSE AND PUBLIC NEED

Public debate is increasingly shaped by polarization, distrust and unequal access to the spaces where opinions are formed. Minority, diaspora, youth and women voices are often discussed without being fully included. Dialogue Rooms Norway will create open, carefully moderated physical meetings where disagreement can be expressed safely, tested against other experiences and turned into democratic participation.

ACTIVITIES AND METHOD

The project will deliver four free public meetings, each designed for 60-100 participants. Every meeting combines a short factual framing, two or three invited perspectives, facilitated table dialogue and an open plenary. The method draws on structured exploration, exchange and reflection so participants listen actively, challenge assumptions and identify practical common ground.

- Freedom of expression across disagreement
- Belonging, identity and democratic participation
- Media, misinformation and the language of conflict
- From polarization to practical local cooperation

PUBLIC RELEVANCE AND ACCESSIBILITY

The meetings will be publicly announced and open without charge. Outreach will combine local associations, schools, municipal networks and The Dialogue Platform's digital channels. Moderation and interpretation will be adapted to participant needs. Representation across age, gender and background will be built into speaker selection, while photos or short clips will only be shared with consent.

EXPECTED RESULTS

- 4 moderated public dialogue meetings
- 240-400 participants in total
- 4 concise public event summaries
- 1 final learning note with recommendations

SUCCESS MEASURES

- Attendance and participant diversity
- At least 75% report greater understanding of another perspective
- New collaborations or follow-up actions recorded after each meeting

PROVISIONAL BUDGET

Facilitation and moderation	40,000
Venue and technical delivery	32,000
Guest travel and honoraria	24,000
Interpretation and accessibility	20,000
Outreach and design	18,000
Documentation and evaluation	16,000
Administration and contingency	10,000

Total project cost: NOK 160,000

Fritt Ord: NOK 100,000 | Own, volunteer and partner contribution: NOK 60,000

APPLICANT CAPACITY

The Dialogue Platform is an independent, non-profit initiative based in Lillestrom. It has organized seminars, workshops and public dialogues in cooperation with community actors, with approximately 380 direct participants across 11 activities and more than 40,000 combined online views reported to date.

CONTACT

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